



AVERY BENNETT | PERSONAL BRAND AUDIT

a4bennet@uwaterloo.ca | [LinkedIn](#) | [Personal Website](#) | [Curriculum Vitae](#)

MISSION

To bring quantitative reasoning to questions that matter, in policy, in markets, and in the ordinary economic life most people never think to model, drawing on formal training in economics, econometrics, management, and on the ability to understand a problem thoroughly rather than sufficiently. I intend to do so with the care, openness and collaborative habit that allow good work to be built on by others.

VISION

To grow into a practitioner whose analysis is relied upon for its rigour and its honesty, whose presence in a research group or a policy team makes the collective work better than it would otherwise have been, and in time, to widen access to quantitative economics for those who follow, so that the field draws on a fuller range of minds than it does today.

CREDENTIALS

EDUCATION

University of Waterloo

- Bachelor of Arts, Honours Economics
 - Econometrics Specialization,
 - Management Studies Minor

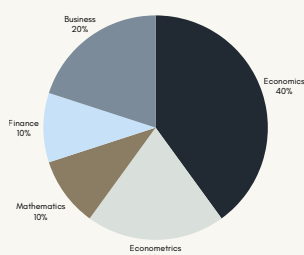


Figure 1: Degree Breakdown

EXPERIENCE

- Teaching Assistant in Microeconomics and Macroeconomics
- Private Tutor
- Economics Program Ambassador
- Service Sector Operations

PROJECTS & INITIATIVES

- Economics Program Ambassador
- Economics Program External Review Involvement
- Published R package on CRAN
- Applied econometrics project on the wage returns of graduate education

WHO AM I?

"This course will change how you view the world," my first microeconomics professor told us on day one. I didn't believe him. By the end of the term, I'd switched my major.

My name is Avery Bennett, and I am an Honours Economics student at the University of Waterloo. My trajectory into economics was indirect and unexpected, strange, if you will. Math had always been my favourite subject, the one place where a problem was either right or wrong, nothing subjective about it. But the world itself was never that simple, and I was curious about it anyway. I was curious about why things worked the way they did, why some systems produced outcomes that didn't seem fair, but I didn't have a framework built for questions that messy. When university came, I ultimately chose science over math, applying only to science programs and ignoring the few individuals around me who suggested Economics or Engineering. I didn't know much about them, and wasn't very compelled by them at the time. As a result, I spent an entire year studying biomedical science without realizing I'd been sitting parallel to economics the whole time, close enough that I'd walked past it more than once, without ever really looking.

My Economics degree has equipped me with upper-year coursework in microeconomic theory, macroeconomics, business cycle theory, econometric theory, applied econometrics, applications in money, banking, and finance, as well as calculus and linear algebra. I have concurrently been completing a Management Minor, requiring courses in marketing, entrepreneurship, business strategy, human resource management, and accounting. Alongside that, my arts breadth requirements have added academic writing, communication, social sciences, philosophy, and culture. In combination, I have developed what I consider the broadest foundation any academic plan can offer. A foundation this broad might look unfocused from the outside, but it's precisely what lets me combine technical depth with the judgment and communication to actually make use of it.

This is a capability I have already executed in practice. During my time at Waterloo, I was required to conduct a research project. We were simply told to go write an applied econometric paper on whatever we wanted, and for the first time, I had to actually think about a question I cared about, rather than having one handed to me. I chose to estimate the wage returns to graduate education across Canada, with my research centered on two main questions: Is graduate school worth pursuing, and does it matter where in Canada you're located? It was a process of independently working through the entire research workflow, from cleaning 980,868 observations of Canadian census observations, and building models using OLS, Tobit, and instrumental variables. The open-endedness of the assignment taught me that the theory only takes you so far. What actually matters is being able to justify your own approach, choosing which tools to use and why, in service of a question you are deeply interested in.

Statistical Tools		Research Design	
R (Programming...)	MATLAB	Difference in Dif...	LDV Models
STATA	Dynare	Instrumental Va...	DSGE Models
Data Management		Presentation	
Excel	SQL	LaTeX	Powerpoint
	GitHub	RStudio	Canva

Figure 2: Key Skills

Consistency • Purpose • Curiosity • Detail • Resourcefulness • Collaboration • Empowerment • Balance • Focus
Integrity • Logic • Structure • Accountability • Precision • Empirical Rigour • Adaptability • Action • Growth

GOALS OBJECTIVES, & CONSTRAINTS



Current Objective: To graduate with a strong academic record and secure admission to a Master's program in Economics.



In the Next Year: To gain real professional exposure through a research assistantship, policy-adjacent role, or financial sector position.



Ten Years: To establish myself as someone whose quantitative work is trusted for its rigor and clarity, in whichever of these fields I settle into.



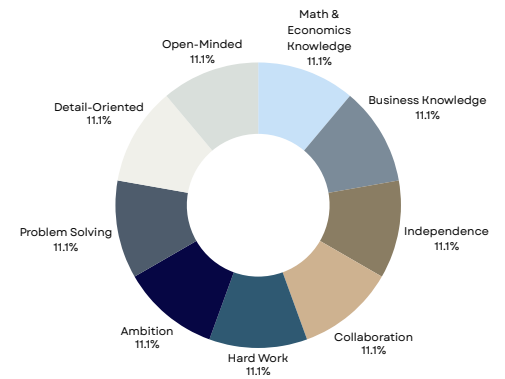
Across My Career: To have devoted myself to work I actually cared about, not just work I was technically capable of doing.

The primary challenges I face include limited direct professional experience relative to my academic credentials and a network that hasn't yet caught up to my technical training. To close these gaps, I need to reach professionals already working in economic policy, research, and finance who can evaluate how my training can translate into real capability, potential mentors who can accelerate that translation, and peers moving through this same transition alongside me. What I want all of them to understand, and remember, is that I am genuinely thorough, that I finish things past the point where "good enough" would let me stop, and that I bring an open mind rather than a narrow, predetermined view of where this training can be applied, so that when an opportunity comes up, I'm the person they think to bring it to.

PERSONAL BRAND ASSETS

FUNCTIONAL BENEFITS	UNIQUE ASSETS	BRAND CORE	BRAND VALUES, IDENTITY, AND PERSONALITY
- Reliable Under Constraints - Translation Between Technical and Non-Technical Audiences - Self Direction	- Breadth of Subject Matter - Intellectual Curiosity - Highly Engaged - Problem Solving - Academic Consistency	I believe in genuinely earning what I achieve, and in drawing on real experience and meaningful thinking to make careful, intentional decisions.	- Discipline - Following tasks through completion. - Work should serve a real purpose, not exist for its own sake - Consistency

CORE STRENGTHS & KEY BRAND INSIGHTS



EVIDENCE

My claims above are supported by a consistent track record. I hold an 88.9% cumulative average in Honours Economics, placing me in the top 3% of economics undergraduates at Waterloo, a program with a large and competitive cohort. My academic standing has been long and continuous, as I've maintained Term Distinction consecutively since I began univeristy. Additionally, I've been trusted to teach and evaluate university level coursework as a teaching assistant across two economics courses. My progression at Bingemans, from host to expeditor to server over a nearly five-year tenure, follows the same trajectory in a completely different setting. As I prove my capability, I get handed more responsibility, and I take it seriously enough to keep earning it. I think the people I've actually worked with put it best: professors have called me hardworking, my family calls me dependable, friends call me strategic, and coworkers call me productive.

COMPARATIVE ADVANTAGE

As I enter the industry, what sets me apart is the combination of mathematical ability, working technical skills in R, and, most distinctively, the ability to ask social science questions that matter and knowing how to build something that answers them. Economics sits at the intersection of social science and math in a way most STEM degrees don't, and that intersection is where the real differential lies. Math majors are known for reasoning elegantly through a complicated proof, and computer science students for writing complex code efficiently, but neither discipline trains the third piece the way economics does. We're taught to construct models where each term serves a purpose, and to impose assumptions that carry consequences for what the result can and can't actually claim about the real world. Knowing where those assumptions hold, and where they fail, is a skill in its own right, separate from the ability to solve the model in the first place. Turning something purely quantitative into a result is a barrier for most degrees, too. A regression output or a system of equations means little without the narrative connecting it to a real-world problem, and that translation is where I believe economics training earns its place over a purely technical degree.

A few other things set me apart beyond that core combination. I've developed excellent time-management through balancing full-time coursework while working two jobs for most of my degree, which meant learning how to manage competing demands in a way that could consistently meet deadlines. Learning to thrive in this type of environment, service work especially, allowed me to communicate and problem-solve, under pressure. When serving at one of the region's largest recreational destinations, the unexpected is routine. You might get two tables of thirty arriving at once, a backed-up kitchen, run out of cutlery mid-rush, and still have to manage the floor, regardless. It's a test of composure, a reminder that you can't always determine what happens, only how you respond to it.